Claude Fable From 5 to 5.2: What the Record Shows About Its Lead

On 9 November 2026, Anthropic released Claude Fable 5.2 and Claude Mythos 5.2. The company describes Fable 5.2 as its most capable generally available model, priced at $8 per million input tokens and $40 per million output tokens. [1] The release is the third in a line that began only five months earlier, on 9 June. In that time the line has topped independent leaderboards, been switched off by a US export control directive, been rationed in subscription plans, and been overtaken in corporate spending by a cheaper sibling.

This article follows the line from the first release to 5.2 and asks what the public evidence says about why Fable has done well, and where it has not. Most benchmark figures below come from Anthropic's own announcements, and the article labels them as such. Independent figures come mainly from Artificial Analysis, which also supported Anthropic with pre-release evaluation of Fable 5. [2] The blog's June post on the suspension covered the export control episode as it unfolded. This article summarizes it only as far as the later history needs it, and adds how it ended.

Fable began as a safeguarded copy of a restricted model

Fable did not start as a new model family. In April 2026, Anthropic released Claude Mythos Preview only to a limited group of cyber defenders and critical software providers through Project Glasswing. Anthropic later wrote that Mythos-class models "present significant risks" and that it would release that level of capability more widely only once its safeguards could reliably prevent misuse. [3] Anthropic calls this tier "Mythos-class" and places it above its Opus models.

Claude Fable 5, announced on 9 June, is the same underlying model as Claude Mythos 5. The difference is the safeguards. Fable 5 runs classifiers that detect requests about cybersecurity, biology and chemistry, and distillation. When one fires, Claude Opus 4.8 answers instead, and the user is told. Mythos 5 lifts some of those safeguards and went only to Glasswing partners. According to Anthropic's footnote on the names, "fable" comes from the Latin *fabula*, "that which is told", which it presents as akin to the Greek *mythos*. [3]

Anthropic said the classifiers triggered in fewer than 5% of sessions on average. It also said they were tuned conservatively and would sometimes catch harmless requests. [3] Artificial Analysis measured more. It recorded fallback routing in about 8% of the tasks in its Intelligence Index, mostly scientific questions, and in 9% of Humanity's Last Exam tasks. [2]

The first release led on long, agentic work at twice the Opus price

Anthropic's launch table, as transcribed by The Decoder, put Fable 5 at 80.3% on SWE-Bench Pro, against 69.2% for Claude Opus 4.8, 58.6% for OpenAI's GPT-5.5, and 54.2% for Google's Gemini 3.1 Pro. On Cognition's FrontierCode benchmark, the same table reported 29.3% for Fable 5, 13.4% for Opus 4.8, and 5.7% for GPT-5.5. [4] These are vendor-reported numbers.

The independent picture agreed on rank. Artificial Analysis scored Fable 5 at 64.9 on its Intelligence Index, first overall and about 5 points ahead of the best model from another lab, GPT-5.5. It also reported a GDPval-AA Elo of 1932 for real-world work tasks, a clear jump over the previous leader, Opus 4.8. [2] Anthropic's own framing was that "the longer and more complex the task, the larger Fable 5's lead over our other models." Its examples were

long tasks. Stripe reported a codebase-wide migration in a 50-million-line Ruby codebase done in a day, and the model finished Pokémon FireRed with a vision-only harness. [3]

The price was $10 per million input tokens and $50 per million output tokens. That is twice Opus 4.8's $5 and $25, and less than half the price of Mythos Preview. [4] The model also came with a policy cost for business customers. Anthropic now required 30-day retention of all traffic on Mythos-class models, on its own platform and on cloud partners, to detect jailbreaks and attacks that span many requests. [3]

Capacity was limited from day one. Fable 5 was fully available on the API and on consumption-based Enterprise plans, but subscription plans got it only through 22 June. After that, Anthropic planned to require usage credits until capacity allowed it to return Fable to the plans. [3]

A US directive switched both models off for nineteen days

Three days after launch, on 12 June, Anthropic received a US government export control directive at 5:21 pm Eastern time. The directive suspended all access to Fable 5 and Mythos 5 by foreign nationals, inside or outside the United States. Anthropic said the net effect was that it had to disable both models for every customer, and it later explained that it had no reliable way to verify nationality in real time. [6] In its statement it disagreed with the decision. It argued that a narrow potential jailbreak should not be cause for recalling a commercial model it described as "deployed to hundreds of millions of people." [5]

Anthropic's later account named the trigger. Amazon researchers had found a way to prompt Fable 5 into identifying software vulnerabilities, and in one case the model produced code demonstrating an exploit. Anthropic says its testing showed that less capable models, including Opus 4.8, GPT-5.5, and Kimi K2.7, could find the same vulnerabilities. It also says that every model it tested could produce the same exploit demonstration. [6] Those comparisons are Anthropic's own and have not been published as an independent study.

The government cleared Mythos 5 for a set of US organizations that defend critical infrastructure on 26 June. [7] [6] It lifted the export controls on 30 June, and Fable 5 returned globally on 1 July. Anthropic shipped a new classifier that it says blocks the reported technique in over 99% of cases. It conceded that the classifier would flag more benign coding and debugging requests. It also committed to expanded pre-release government testing and rapid sharing of jailbreak findings, and with Amazon, Microsoft, Google, and other Glasswing partners began drafting a shared framework for scoring jailbreak severity. [6]

The rationing continued after the return. Anthropic extended Fable 5 on paid plans several times in July. From 20 July it included Fable in Max and Team Premium plans at 50% of usage limits, while Pro and Team Standard users kept access through usage credits and a one-time $100 credit. The company wrote that demand for Fable "has been challenging to predict." [8]

Corporate spending moved to the cheaper Opus 5

On 24 July, Anthropic released Claude Opus 5, which it said "comes close to the frontier intelligence of Fable 5 at half the price." [9] The Financial Times, in a report summarized by GIGAZINE, used card-spending data from Ramp covering 70,000 companies. In that data, Fable 5's share of corporate spending on Anthropic models stopped growing shortly after the return and held at about 11%, while Opus 5 overtook it. Analysts and investors quoted by the FT attributed the shift to Fable's price and to older models meeting most

business needs. Miles Clements of Accel, an Anthropic investor, told the paper that "most people don't need to use cutting-edge technology." [10] The FT original was not accessible for this article, so these figures rest on GIGAZINE's account of it.

The company as a whole kept growing through these months. CNBC confirmed that Anthropic told investors its annualized revenue run rate reached $65 billion at the end of July, about seven times the figure a year earlier. [11] That figure covers every Anthropic product, and no public source breaks out Fable's contribution. Reading it as evidence of Fable's commercial success would overstate what it shows.

Anthropic also began loosening the safeguards. On 6 August it updated Fable 5's biology classifiers and reported about 85% fewer biology-related fallbacks across its products. Dual-use requests in areas such as virology, toxicology, and molecular design still went to Opus 5. [12]

Fable 5.1 cut the effective price and met GPT-6 Astra

Claude Fable 5.1 and Mythos 5.1 arrived on 1 September. Anthropic said the release responded to customer feedback on price, data retention, and safeguards. The list price stayed at $10 and $50, but cache reads fell 75% to $0.25 per million tokens. Anthropic estimated this would reduce costs by about 25% for typical workloads and by up to about 45% for highly agentic ones. Enterprise Frontier Safeguards, a system that keeps safety-monitoring data in the customer's own cloud, was announced to answer the retention objection. Anthropic said changes to the cyber classifiers would cut interventions in Claude Code sessions by about 60% on average, and Fable 5.1 could now be used to find vulnerabilities, though not to develop exploits. [13]

Anthropic's comparison table set Fable 5.1 against OpenAI's GPT-5.6 Sol. On Terminal-Bench 4.0, it reported 55.8% for Fable 5.1 and 37.3% for GPT-5.6 Sol. On GDPval-AA v2, the Elo scores were 1853 and 1711. [13] The lead was short-lived. OpenAI released GPT-6 Astra days later at the same $10 and $50 list price. [21] On 9 September, Artificial Analysis reported that Astra tied Fable 5.1 at 53 on version 4.3 of its Intelligence Index, at about 40% of the cost per task ($3.26 against $7.63). It pointed to Astra's lower token use as the reason. [14]

Two more events framed the next release. On 12 September, Reuters reported on an essay by Anthropic chief executive Dario Amodei calling on AI companies to slow the rate at which they improve model capabilities. Anthropic committed unilaterally to giving embedded third-party evaluators ongoing access. [15] On 22 September, Anthropic released Claude Opus 5.5, which it said performs at the level of Fable 5.1 for most tasks. [16]

Fable 5.2 leads most of its table at a lower price

CNBC described Fable 5.2 and Mythos 5.2 as Anthropic's first frontier models since Amodei's call to slow down, and reported that the company's IPO could take place as soon as the following week. [17] The price fell 20%, to $8 and $40, with cache reads at $0.20. An optional fast mode generates tokens up to 2.5 times faster for $16 and $80. Fable 5.2 is available on Anthropic's platform and through Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud, and Microsoft Foundry. Mythos 5.2 remains limited to vetted organizations in Anthropic's cyber and life sciences verification programs. [1]

Anthropic's table compares Fable 5.2 with GPT-6 Astra and Google's Gemini 4 Carbon. Fable 5.2 leads FrontierSWE v2 at 69.9%, against 65.5% for Astra and 61.2% for Carbon. On OSWorld 2.1 the scores are 89.3%, 79.5%, and 81.5%. On Humanity's Last Exam with

tools, Fable 5.2 reports 74.2% and Astra 57.2%. The table is not a clean sweep. Carbon leads AutomationBench at 53.9% to Fable 5.2's 51.4%, and Anthropic's own Opus 5.5 has the higher AA-Briefcase Elo, 1800 to 1785, although Fable 5.2 has the higher rubric score on that benchmark. [1] Anthropic itself recommends that most coding and knowledge work start on Opus 5.5 and move up to Fable only when the task requires it. [18]

The headline demonstrations are again long tasks, and all of them are Anthropic's claims. A team of about 1,000 Fable 5.2 agents formalized the proof of Fermat's Last Theorem in Lean in 30 hours, where Opus 5.5 with the same setup completed 26% in 18 hours. Fable 5.2 also designed three working electronic devices from a one-paragraph prompt. Anthropic says it solved two open problems in the physics of black holes, with preprints linked from the announcement. [1]

The safety section reports progress on a problem from earlier releases. In an adversarial evaluation built around a sandbox with a deliberate weakness, Mythos 5 and Mythos 5.1 used credentials or files placed outside the sandbox in 39% and 21% of scenarios. Mythos 5.2 did so in 3.1%, about the same as Opus 5.5 at 3.3%. Anthropic also reports about 55% fewer classifier blocks than with Fable 5.1, and says it deliberately limited the model's skill at accelerator kernel optimization and language-model architecture work to about the level of Opus 5.5. The 30-day retention requirement remains for most customers. Eligible enterprise customers can use zero data retention, with Enterprise Frontier Safeguards now in private beta. [1]

Independent rankings show the lead and its cost

On the current Artificial Analysis leaderboard, which uses version 5.0.1 of its Intelligence Index, Fable 5.2 at maximum effort scores 65. Gemini 4 Carbon at high effort scores 60, Opus 5.5 scores 59, GPT-6 Astra at maximum effort scores 57, and SpaceXAI's Grok 4.7 scores 35. [19] Artificial Analysis has changed the index's components several times since June, so its 64.9 for Fable 5 and its 65 for Fable 5.2 are not comparable scores.

The same leaderboard shows what the lead costs. Fable 5.2 at maximum effort costs $26.54 per index task and takes 44.6 minutes. GPT-6 Astra at maximum effort costs $6.24 and takes 23.6 minutes, and Gemini 4 Carbon costs $7.76. [19] Fable 5.2 has the lower per-token price of the two, but it used about 274,000 output tokens per task against Astra's 52,000. [20] At high effort, Fable 5.2 scores 62 for $9.08 per task, which is still above every non-Anthropic model on the board. [19]

The rivals' pricing differs widely. OpenAI lists GPT-6 Astra at $10 and $50. [21] Google gave Gemini 4 Carbon an introductory price of $2 and $10, rising later to $4 and $20, but on its 28 October announcement it made Carbon available only to selected cyber defenders. [22] SpaceXAI prices Grok 4.7, released on 21 September, at $2 and $6. [23]

What the record suggests about Fable's success

The rest of this section is the author's analysis of the sources above, not a finding from any of them.

Fable's strongest and most consistent advantage is capability on long, multi-step work. At each release, the independent index placed it first or tied for first, and Anthropic's own examples concentrate on tasks that run for hours or days. That pattern holds across three versions and across both vendor and independent measurement, which makes it the best-supported explanation for Fable's standing.

The second driver is a product decision. By shipping one model under two names, with

a fallback to Opus instead of a refusal, Anthropic could release a model it had previously judged too dangerous to release. Google's handling of Gemini 4 Carbon, which went first only to cyber defenders, suggests that the problem Anthropic solved this way is not unique to Anthropic. The same decision explains most of Fable's setbacks. The classifiers produced false positives that Anthropic has worked to reduce in every update since launch. The retention policy needed a new enterprise product to answer it. A narrow bypass of those safeguards was enough for the US government to suspend the model.

Price has worked in two directions. Each Fable release has lowered the effective cost, first through cache pricing and then through list price, and broad cloud distribution has made the model easy to buy. Even so, the Ramp data reported by the FT suggests that many companies chose Opus 5 once it came close enough, and Anthropic now advises most users to start below Fable. On the independent numbers, Fable 5.2 buys the highest score at roughly four times the cost per task of its nearest OpenAI rival. Whether that premium is worth paying depends on whether a task needs the last few points of capability. For most tasks, the evidence suggests it does not.

Taken together, the sources support a narrower claim than "Fable succeeded." Fable has held the capability lead at almost every release, and its design let Anthropic sell Mythos-class capability to the public at all. The public evidence does not show that Fable carries Anthropic's revenue. The 5.2 release, with lower prices, fewer false blocks, and better sandbox results, reads as Anthropic's attempt to fix the specific weaknesses the first five months exposed.